

THE LATTER-DAY SAINTS'

MILLENNIAL STAR.

Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.—MATTHEW V: 16.

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PRIESTHOOD, AND THE RIGHT OF SUCCESSION.

[CONTINUED FROM PAGE 501.]

LUCY SMITH, mother of the Prophet, is reported to have said—by the advocates of the Josephite faction—that young Joseph would yet lead the Church. So far as Lucy Smith is concerned, I believe that she has been misrepresented—absolutely misrepresented—for only yesterday I was going through one of the journals of the late President John Taylor, in which are recorded several communications from Sister Lucy Smith in which she urges the right of William B. Smith, the only remaining brother of the Prophet, to the Presidency. Her pleadings and her efforts, after the death of her sons Joseph and Hyrum, were all made in support of the claims of William. He, too, laid claim to the right of the Presidency of the Church; and when I visited him but a few years ago, and had a conversation with him upon the subject, I discovered that he thought himself harshly dealt with by the Apostles at Nauvoo, and by President Young in particular. He based his claim to the Presidency by his being the *brother* to the Prophet Joseph; and, would you believe it, he, too, had Scripture to quote in support of his claim? He called attention to that passage in the Acts of the Apostles where, upon some question arising through the teaching of Paul at Antioch, the Elders and the Apostles were called together at Jerusalem to consider the matter. After Peter had given his testimony, after Paul and Barnabas had spoken, then James, the brother of the Lord, arose and said: "My sentence is that we trouble not them which from among the Gentiles are turned to God," etc. From this William concluded that James gave the decision of the council, and if he gave the decision of the council, then he must have been the president of the council, and if the president of the council, then the President of the Church. If James, the brother of the Lord, succeeded

THE ISLE OF SKULLS.

ON the lonely, wind-swept island of San Nicolas, eighty miles off the coast of Ventura County, California, where, as far back as the memory of man runs, hundreds of white skeletons have dotted the valleys and hillsides, local archaeologists are now busy gathering the relics of a strange, extinct race. The island is ten miles long and oval in shape, being four miles across at the widest part. Strange utensils of serpentine, sandstone, and steatite are found there among the human bones, and the island and its erstwhile inhabitants have a history so curious that it is difficult of comprehension. In 1835 the *padres* of Santa Barbara, learning that there were but sixteen of the strange Indian race then living there, determined to rescue them from the island. They went over in a sloop and succeeded as they thought, in getting all on board. At the last moment an Indian woman returned for her child, and, one of the frequent storms of the channel islands springing up, the sloop was driven away without her. The sloop went on the rocks of Point Conception and all on board were lost.

Sixteen years later, Captain George Nidever and two men went from the coast on a sloop to hunt otter off San Nicolas. On landing, they were, like Crusoe, astonished to discover human footprints in the sand. They saw no one, however, and a storm compelled them to put to sea. It was two years thereafter that the adventurous captain, revolving in his mind the sight of footprints in the uncanny island, determined to go and discover and bring over the lonely woman of whom he had vaguely heard. Men accompanied him, and at length they saw on the surf-beaten shore a woman with long, tawny hair, dressed in a queer garb of colored bird-skins, and scraping with a bone knife the blubber from a seal. They surrounded and approached her stealthily, and, although suddenly confronted, she did not appear in the least afraid, but smiled, and then, falling on her knees, prayed to the sun. The wild woman offered no objection when by signs she was made to understand that she was to go with them in the boat. They reached Santa Barbara across the rough sea, and the first thing the Indian woman saw was Dr. S. L. Shaw, now eighty years old and yet living there, riding a horse. She had never seen nor heard of any object like it, and thought the man and horse were one, and she knelt on the shore and offered her devotions to it.

Two weeks afterward the last inhabitant of rock-ribbed, tempest-tossed San Nicolas died from eating food to which she was unaccustomed, furnished by her rescuers, and the curtain fell on her race for ever. Wild dogs had eaten her child. Her dress of red and blue feathers, a wonderful creation of barbaric hands, was sent to the Pope of Rome. Relic hunters have gathered mortars, pestles, ollas, toy steatite canoes, and other curious things there for some years past, and shipped them to various Eastern and European universities. Skeletons and parts of skeletons have also been collected in large numbers, but to-day the bones of thousands of Indians are scattered about there. Some lie face down, indicating that they have fallen in battle. There are so many human relics there that San Nicolas

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is known as the Isle of Skulls. "The lonely island, whose highest part is but 1,040 feet above the sea," said a resident of Ventura recently, "is noted for the high artistic class of many of its relics. Had the woman rescued, then fifty-two years old, not died, a story passing strange would no doubt have been told of the race so long hemmed in by the waste of waters about. As it is, much of the story is shrouded in mystery for ever."—*San Francisco Examiner*.

FACTS AND EVENTS.

Emperor William of Germany reached England on August 2, on a visit to Queen Victoria.

At Dewsbury, Yorkshire, England, on August 5, a coalpit was suddenly flooded and six workmen drowned.

By the bursting of some hidden springs in the Innan mine, Japan, on July 6, sixty Japanese miners were drowned.

There were 3245 fever patients in the London hospitals on August 7, most of them being sufferers from scarlet fever.

A heavy sandstorm swept over Phoenix, Arizona, on August 6, destroying a number of frail houses. Several Indians were killed.

The Russian town of Rzeche was destroyed by fire on August 4, fourteen lives being lost and two thousand people rendered homeless.

President Harrison signed the law passed by Congress limiting the time that mechanics shall be employed on the public works to an eight hour day.

The Argentine torpedo catcher *Rosales*, which went down in the recent storm outside the River Plate, had on board seventy persons; all were drowned.

The States of Dakota and Minnesota have quarantined against Manitoba, Dominion of Canada, owing to the prevalence of smallpox in the latter state.

Cholera is on the increase in Russia, and its prevalence in Moscow is now admitted in the Russian official reports. The epidemic is also spreading in Persia.

Over 5,000 deaths from cholera are reported to have taken place in Russia and the Caucasus during the month of July. Instructions have been issued for the closing of all educational institutions until September.

On Tuesday, July 26, the steamship *City of Paris* arrived in New York, having made the ocean passage from Queenstown to Sandy Hook in 5 days, 15 hours and 58 minutes—the fastest passage on record up to that date.

A dispatch from Honduras, August 3, says that the revolutionists there succeeded, after sanguinary fighting, in which the late president was killed, in overthrowing the government, and have organized a new one to suit themselves.

An earthquake in Mexico, on July 30, caused great destruction of property and the loss of many lives at the city of San Cristobel. Fifteen thousand people were deprived of shelter by their dwellings being thrown down.

A riot took place at Duquesne, near Homestead, Pennsylvania, on August 4, between a body of strikers and some non-union men, in which a number of persons were hurt. The military had to be called out to suppress the disturbance.

An awful tragedy was reported from the City of Mexico on August 3. While a marriage reception was in progress, the bride was shot dead by a disappointed lover, who, after firing at the bridegroom with fatal effect, turned the weapon upon himself and fell dead on the body of the bride.

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